

in scores is within 30-40 per cent of the laptop that you could get for the money that you are willing to spend, then we'd recommend you hold off on your purchase.

It simply does not make sense to get your hands on a new machine at this point. What you could do is get your machine fully serviced and remove all the gunk that might have built up and would be blocking the cooling vents. A thermal paste replacement should also go a long long way.

Now, if you were from the other side and had to buy your first gaming machine, then for starters, read the words of our SKOAR! Legend, Trigger-Happy's words carefully -

"A good processor can make a difference when it comes to gaming performance. Many games assign certain

tasks to the CPU and are not entirely reliant on the GPU for performance. In situations such as these, the weaker (and older) CPU becomes the bottleneck as the GPU is certainly capable of pulling more frames...

... As newer generations of gaming laptops are released to the market, gaming laptops with older GPUs and hardware naturally become a lot more pocket friendly."

Take that in. If you are looking for a new machine, while its specs may



Not bad at all!

look excellent on paper, the real-world performance might not be up to the mark due to several factors. So, ensure that all your needs are being met with the configuration and that that particular SKU that you are planning to spend your hard-earned money on does actually make sense.

Also, unlike earlier, when you had to spend a considerable amount of money to get decent performance out of laptops. For gamers who are starting out, a budget of about ₹80,000 should be sufficient. In the market right now, the 80k mark is the sweet spot. After that, the bump that you get for the money that you spend is very low.

Focus on getting the most for your money. The ideal specs that you should look for in a laptop to game on and one that would last you a while are:

*If your laptop comes with 8GB of RAM with expandability available, with the rest of the specs being what you desire, then you can go for it and add another stick of RAM later.

**When looking at storage, ideally, look for a laptop that has a standard expandability slot available for use.

***A thunderbolt port will come in handy to connect an eGPU to your laptop or provide extra display outputs using a hub.

We hope that this short guide will help you get your laptop-buying-related queries sorted. However, if questions still arise, then drop an email to Agent001, and he'd be happy to help! *

Benchmark	Use
FireStrike Ultra	4K gaming with DirectX 11
FireStrike Extreme	DirectX 11 gaming PCs
FireStrike	DirectX 11 gaming PCs
TimeSpy Extreme	4K gaming with DirectX 12
TimeSpy	DirectX 12 gaming PCs

Component	Ideal Specs
Processor	AMD Ryzen 7 4000 series or Intel Core i5 12th Gen or above
Screen	144Hz FHD display
RAM *	16GB
Storage **	512GB NVMe SSD
Ports ***	2x USB 3.0 ports, 1x HDMI out, 1x Ethernet jack, 1x Thunderbolt port
GPU	NVIDIA RTX 3050 or above